rather fragile international order associated with the international system.[36]

Traditionally, the utility of military power has been upheld by several strategic thinkers and political philosophers and its value is self-evident despite mounting criticisms against its usage. Karl Von Clausewitz, the Prussian strategic thinker, gave a dictum in which he said “war is the continuation of politics by other means”.

His book ‘*Von Kriegg*’ (*On War*) contains ample examples from history to illustrate the various concepts propunded by him. Some of the prominent Clausewitzian principles are:

1. War must never be seen as a purpose to itself, but as a means of physically forcing one’s will on an opponent.
2. The military objectives in war that support one’s political objectives fall into two broad types: “war to achieve limited aims” and war to “disarm” the enemy: “to render [him] politically helpless or militarily impotent”.
3. The course of war will tend to favour the party who has more resolve and resources.

Carr[37] in his *Twenty Years Crisis* upheld that the “supreme importance of the military instrument lies in the fact that the *ultima ratio* of power in international relations is war”. Every act of a state from the aspect of its power is directed to war not as a desirable weapon but as a weapon which it may require as the last resort. He said that “war lurks in the background of international politics just as revolution lurks in the background of domestic politics”. Therefore, potential war becomes a dominant factor in international politics and military strength becomes a recognized standard political value. Military power is not only an essential element in the life of the state but it sometimes becomes an end in itself. Carr contends that fewer wars are fought for trade or territorial expansion, and he points out that most serious wars had been fought to make one’s country militarily strong or for preventing another country from becoming militarily stronger. He says that “the principal cause of war is war itself”.

Quincy Wright‡ in his *Study of Wars* defines war as “a violent contact